

Compare and Contrast - Workbook 2

Use contrasts to explain choices, attitudes, and consequences.

Strategy reminder

Choose one comparison basis - goal, method, attitude, result, cost, timing, or effect - and describe both sides on that same basis.

Two Neighborhood Meetings

Text 1

At the first neighborhood meeting, the chairperson followed a strict agenda and limited each speaker to two minutes. The meeting ended on time, but several residents said complex concerns were cut short. At the second meeting, the chairperson grouped speakers by topic and allowed longer discussion. More ideas were explored, but the meeting ran forty minutes late.

1. What is one important difference between the meetings?

- A. Only the first included residents
- B. The first emphasized time limits, while the second allowed longer discussion
- C. Only the second had a chairperson
- D. Both ended at exactly the same time

2. How are the outcomes similar?

- A. Both produced exactly the same complaints
- B. Both involved a tradeoff between meeting structure and participant needs
- C. Both ran forty minutes late
- D. Both prevented all discussion

Two Study Partners

Text 2

Sofia begins assignments by making a detailed outline and dividing the work across several evenings. Amir reads all the source material first, then writes a complete draft in one long session and revises it the next day. Both usually submit work on time, but Sofia says her method reduces stress, while Amir says he understands the whole topic better before he begins writing.

3. How are Sofia and Amir similar?

- A. Both use the same writing schedule
- B. Both have a method that helps them complete assignments on time
- C. Both write the entire draft in one session
- D. Both say outlining reduces stress

4. What is the main contrast in their approaches?

- A. Sofia plans and spreads the work out; Amir gathers information first and drafts in a concentrated session
- B. Sofia reads sources and Amir does not
- C. Only Amir revises
- D. Only Sofia submits work

Two Transit Proposals

Text 3

Proposal A would add express buses during rush hour on the busiest route. It could begin within six months using existing buses, but it would serve mainly commuters on that corridor. Proposal B would create smaller neighborhood shuttles connecting several areas to train stations. It would reach more neighborhoods but require new vehicles and at least eighteen months to launch.

5. How are the proposals similar?

- A. Both aim to improve connections within the transit system
- B. Both can launch within six months
- C. Both use only existing buses

D. Both serve one corridor only

6. Which difference is most relevant to how quickly each proposal could begin?

A. Proposal A focuses on rush hour

B. Proposal B reaches more neighborhoods

C. Proposal A can use existing buses, while Proposal B requires new vehicles

D. Both connect people to transit

Review your reasoning

Before checking the key, mark the question that felt hardest. Write one clue that changed your mind and name the distractor that was most tempting.

Answer key and reasoning

1. B - The key procedural difference is how speaking time was managed.

Watch for: Do not compare a feature that both meetings share.

2. B - Each format solved one problem while creating or revealing another tradeoff.

Watch for: A higher-level similarity can connect the role each outcome plays.

3. B - Their methods differ, but both support timely completion.

Watch for: Find the shared result rather than forcing the methods to match.

4. A - A accurately contrasts the sequence and pacing of their methods.

Watch for: A good contrast states both sides in parallel terms.

5. A - Both proposals aim to improve transit access/connections, though they do so differently.

Watch for: A shared purpose is stronger than a shared topic such as "buses."

6. C - Vehicle requirements directly explain the different launch timelines.

Watch for: Choose the contrast that matters for the question, not merely any difference.